PHI363
Topics in Metaphysics & Epistemology



Piet Mondrian, Tableau no 1 (1913)

Categories, Concepts, and Kinds

What are we doing when we group things into different categories and kinds? What are the ways this might go wrong? We will explore this question through the lens of recent work in metaphysics, epistemology, philosophy of language, philosophy of mind, philosophy of art, and social philosophy.

David Sanson
Spring 2027

MW 2:00PM–3:15PM
Stevenson 227A

- What roles do categories and kinds play in our inferential practices?
- Is there a right way to group things—a way that "carves nature at the joints"?
- Might some of our concepts be "defective" or internally incoherent?
- What role does genres play in the production and appreciation of the arts?
- Is the very act of categorizing people or things intrinsically problematic or pernicious?

Prerequisites. phi201 or permission of instructor

www.davidsanson.com/363s2027